

Wednesday, 7 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Rain 18° 11°	BIRMINGHAM Light rain 16° 9°	MANCHESTER Light rain 14° 10°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 12° 8°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Three people have been arrested in connection with a gang accused of helping migrants pretend to be gay to get asylum in the UK.

Home Office immigration enforcement officers carried out a raid, with the gang allegedly charging migrants up to £4,500 for fabricated evidence. This follows a significant investigation into asylum fraud.

CRIME · UK
- 2

A British national has been arrested in connection with an incident near RAF Fairford last month.

This is the seventh arrest in what has become a developing investigation. The specifics of the incident near the Royal Air Force base have not yet been fully disclosed.

SECURITY · UK
- 3

Experts are raising concerns that a rise in babies entering care proceedings could lead to unnecessary adoptions.

A BBC 'File on 4' investigation suggests that with better support for families, many infants might not need to be taken into care. This highlights a critical issue in child welfare.

SOCIAL CARE · UK
- 4

A childminder who left 27 children alone in her home has pleaded guilty to neglect.

Amanda Mathewson, 55, admitted to the charges of neglect and abandoning children in her care at Kirkcaldy Sheriff Court. The case has shocked the local community.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Conservative Party leader Kemi Badenoch has said she would rather have another election than do a deal with Reform UK.

Ms Badenoch also pledged to cut the cost of hiring 21 to 24-year-olds in a move aimed at boosting youth employment. Her comments underscore the current political landscape.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Rosie O'Donnell and Julie Hesmondhalgh are set to star in a new play about the Gisele Pelicot case.**
 The four-hour one-off performance will also feature Adjoa Andoh and Juliet Stevenson. It promises to be a powerful and thought-provoking theatrical event.
ON AIR – A four-hour play – that's quite a commitment! Would you go to see a play that long?
 THEATRE · COMING UP
- 2 Hollywood is buzzing with the news that Paramount has taken over Warner Bros in a massive \$110 billion merger.**
 This huge deal brings together two of the biggest movie studios after months of legal disputes. It's set to shake up the entertainment industry.
ON AIR – This is a massive shake-up in Hollywood! What do you think this could mean for the films and TV shows we see?
 FILM · FUTURE
- 3 Former Little Mix star Jade Thirlwall has described working on a song for Blue Planet III as 'magical'.**
 Jade collaborated with legendary composer Hans Zimmer on an official track for the highly anticipated BBC nature documentary. It's a big step for her solo career.
ON AIR – What a collaboration! Do you think more pop stars should team up with film composers?
 MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 Indian singer Anuv Jain is finding huge success without the usual Bollywood boost, and he's been sharing his future hopes.**
 The star revealed he's very selective about releasing music and discussed his hopes for future collaborations. He's certainly making a name for himself globally.
ON AIR – It's great to see artists breaking through in new ways. Which international artists are you loving right now?
 MUSIC · FUTURE
- 5 Tickets for Glastonbury 2027 have completely sold out in a blistering 42 minutes!**
 Thousands of hopeful festival-goers queued online, eager to secure their spot at Worthy Farm. It just goes to show the enduring popularity of the iconic festival.
ON AIR – Glastonbury sold out in 42 minutes! Were you one of the lucky ones, or are you still trying to get tickets?
 FESTIVAL · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 Cristiano Ronaldo says he won't be retiring from international football, despite admitting he deserves 'punishment' for walking out on Portugal.**
Ronaldo left the squad due to a 'breach of the coach's trust'. This has sparked a lot of debate among fans and pundits about his future with the national team.
ON AIR – Do you think Ronaldo still has a place in international football, or is it time for him to step aside?
FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

- 2 LIV Golf has secured a potential \$300 million investment, aiming to emerge from restructuring before the 2027 season.**
The financing from BC Partners Credit is a significant boost for the controversial golf tour. It signals their intent to continue challenging the traditional golfing establishment.
ON AIR – LIV Golf is making big moves. Do you think it's good for the sport to have this kind of competition?
GOLF · FUTURE

- 3 Novak Djokovic has claimed the 102nd title of his astonishing career after winning the China Open.**
His opponent, Alex de Minaur, retired injured from the final, handing Djokovic another trophy. It's another incredible milestone for the tennis legend.
ON AIR – 102 titles! Is Djokovic the greatest male tennis player of all time?
TENNIS · RESULT

- 4 Paul Farbrace has made a surprise move, leaving Sussex to join Lancashire as their new director of cricket.**
This comes just weeks before he was due to start the same role at Sussex, making it an unexpected turn of events in county cricket. It will certainly be a talking point.
ON AIR – A last-minute switch in county cricket! What do you make of this kind of move in sports management?
CRICKET · UK

- 5 London City Lionesses delivered a stunning performance, putting six goals past Tottenham to end Spurs' unbeaten start to the Women's Super League.**
Alexia Putellas and Kadidiatou Diani both scored twice in a dominant display. It was a clear statement of intent from the Lionesses.
ON AIR – What a result in the Women's Super League! Are you following the WSL this season?
FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists are exploring the delightful phenomenon of 'pet ownership synchronicity', where owners and their furry friends often develop similar daily routines and even expressions.**
Research suggests that spending time together can lead to a fascinating mirroring effect, from nap times to reactions to the postman. It seems our pets truly become part of the family.
- 2 The surprising satisfaction of 'finding a perfectly sized container for leftovers' is a small joy being celebrated by home cooks nationwide.**
There's a quiet sense of triumph when a meal fits just right into a Tupperware, avoiding any awkward spills or wasted space. It's the little victories, isn't it?
- 3 A new study reveals the unexpected boost in mood many receive from 'hearing an old, familiar song on the radio' that they haven't heard in ages.**
That sudden burst of nostalgia and memory can instantly brighten a day, transporting listeners back to happy times. Music truly is a powerful thing.
- 4 Experts are highlighting the calming ritual of 'watering houseplants' as a beneficial practice for mental well-being.**
Taking a moment to nurture something green and watch it thrive can provide a peaceful break from busy schedules. It's a small act with big benefits.
- 5 The charming trend of 'leaving painted kindness rocks' in public places for others to find continues to spread across communities.**
These small, colourful gestures carry uplifting messages or pictures, offering a moment of unexpected cheer to those who discover them. A lovely way to connect.
- 6 Research indicates a growing appreciation for the 'sound of gentle rain on a windowpane' as a natural sleep aid and relaxation tool.**
The consistent, soft drumming can be incredibly soothing, helping to block out other distractions and create a peaceful atmosphere. Perfect for a cosy night in.
- 7 The simple pleasure of 'successfully de-tangling a messy ball of yarn or string' is being recognised for its satisfying conclusion.**
There's a unique sense of accomplishment when you finally unknot a seemingly impossible tangle, leaving you with a perfectly orderly length. A small victory for order!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOX A GOOD SNIFF TO SEE IF IT SMELLS 'TEAS-Y' ENOUGH!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new television series, especially if it's a much-anticipated one. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING ALL THE CUSHIONS ON THE SOFA 'JUST SO' FOR OPTIMAL COMFORT!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'quirky local tradition' or a fun, small-scale event that your town or village does, perhaps annually, that you absolutely love?

What's that unique, charming thing your local area is known for, even if it's just amongst yourselves? Give us a call!

- We all have that 'one particular type of sandwich filling' that we consider our ultimate comfort food – the one that always hits the spot, no matter what.

What's your go-to, absolute favourite sandwich filling? The one you could happily eat for lunch every day? Let us know!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament', because of their perceived wisdom and solemn appearance.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of badgers is a 'brigade', due to their determined and organised foraging habits.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's smallest continent, Australia, is wider than the Moon.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if conditions are right.
- The Great Wall of China is not a single continuous wall, but a series of walls and fortifications.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'richest' soil in the world is found in the Amazon rainforest, supporting incredible biodiversity.
- The unique scent of rain after a dry spell is called petrichor.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.

On this day

Day 280 of the year, 85 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Justina of Padua; Christian feast day: Henry Muhlenberg (some Lutheran Churches, Episcopal Church of the USA); Christian feast day: Osgyth; Christian feast day: Our Lady of the Rosary. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1978 — Omar Benson Miller, American actor
- 1997 — Kira Kosarin, American actress and singer
- 1964 — Paul Stewart, English footballer
- 1986 — Bree Olson, American actress, model, and former pornographic actress
- 1997 — Nicole Maines, American actress, writer, and activist
- 1937 — Chet Powers, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1994)
- 1974 — Allison Munn, American actress
- 1938 — Ann Jones, English tennis player and sportscaster

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — Aeroflot Flight 1080 crashes after takeoff from Koltsovo International Airport, killing 38.
- 1987 — Sikh nationalists declare the independence of Khalistan from India; it is not internationally recognized.
- 2004 — Three bombs explode at Taba and Nuweiba in the Sinai Peninsula, Egypt, killing 34.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2004 — Three bombs explode at Taba and Nuweiba in the Sinai Peninsula, Egypt, killing 34.
- 2016 — In the wake of Hurricane Matthew, the death toll rises to over 800.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — Four men from the Palestine Liberation Front hijack the MS Achille Lauro off the coast of Egypt.
- 1987 — Sikh nationalists declare the independence of Khalistan from India; it is not internationally recognized.
- 1979 — Swissair Flight 316 crashes at Ellinikon International Airport in Athens, Greece, killing 14.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 281 of the year, 84 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Evodus (or Yves); Christian feast day: Blessed John Adams; Christian feast day: Palatias and Laurentia; Christian feast day: Pelagia (Eastern Orthodox and Roman Catholic Churches). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1950 — Robert "Kool" Bell, American singer-songwriter and bass player
- 1950 — Blake Morrison, English poet, author, and academic
- 1961 — Kim Wayans, American actress and comedian
- 1968 — Emily Procter, American actress
- 1985 — Bruno Mars, American singer-songwriter, producer, and actor
- 1993 — Angus T. Jones, American actor
- 1956 — Stephanie Zimbalist, American actress
- 1995 — G Herbo, American rapper

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1990 — First Intifada: Israeli police kill 17 Palestinians and wound over 100 near the Dome of the Rock.
- 2001 — U.S. president George W. Bush announces the establishment of the Office of Homeland Security.
- 1978 — Australia's Ken Warby sets the current world water speed record of 275.97 knots at Blowering Dam, Australia.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The Harrow and Wealdstone rail crash in England kills 112 people.
- 1982 — Poland bans Solidarity and all other trade unions.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar